



Re: Peer Response

by **Mariam Ibrahim Ismail Hasan Almarzooqi** - Thursday, 11 December 2025, 8:08 AM

Your post offers a clear and compelling examination of the ethical challenges Abi faces in relation to statistical practice. You effectively distinguish between appropriate exploratory analysis and unethical selective reporting, grounding your argument in the American Statistical Association's ethical principles. This gives strong support to your position that statisticians should not present findings in a way that misleads stakeholders or conceals uncertainty.

I particularly appreciate how you contextualize Abi's dilemma within broader evidence of industry bias in research outcomes. Citing Lundh et al. (2017) strengthens your point that commercial sponsorship can influence how results are framed. Your inclusion of the concept of p-hacking (Head et al., 2015) further clarifies how selective emphasis on favorable outcomes can distort the scientific record and mislead decision-making.

Your recommendations for Abi, such as documenting concerns, requesting removal from misrepresentative publications, and escalating serious issues, are practical and ethically sound. They demonstrate an understanding of both professional responsibility and real-world challenges.

One suggestion for enhancement would be a brief acknowledgment of how Abi might balance ethical reporting with contractual or workplace pressures, which could make your discussion even more relatable.

Reference:

American Statistical Association (2022) *American Statistical Association ethical guidelines for statistical practice*. Available at: <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.7092386> (Accessed: 9 December 2025).

Head, M.L., Holman, L., Lanfear, R., Kahn, A.T. and Jennions, M.D. (2015) 'The extent and consequences of p-hacking in science', *PLOS Biology*, 13(3), p. e1002106. doi:10.1371/journal.pbio.1002106.

Lundh, A., Lexchin, J., Mintzes, B., Schroll, J.B. and Bero, L. (2017) 'Industry sponsorship and research outcome', *Cochrane Database of Systematic Reviews*, (2), MR000033. doi:10.1002/14651858.MR000033.pub3.